

To know the bit depth of your image, open Image Mode menu. You will see a menu selection that says 8 Bits/Channel. When you open an image in Elements, if this menu command is grayed out, you're working with a 24-bit image, or an image of 8 bits per channel.

It's evident that the higher the bits, the better your image will look. But the printer will accept only 8-bit images. So you need to reduce your images to 8-bit if you are going to print them. If you are not printing them, go nuts with the higher bit sizes.

A point to remember here- when you edit an 8-bit image and move the adjustment sliders too far to the left or right, you can degrade the image. This happens because with an 8-bit image, extreme adjustments destroy the data. Another reason to work with higher bit images.

Basic Photography Terms and Concepts

Once you start delving into the world of photography, you will realise that there are a number of confusing concepts and terms. Some of these terms will even make you wonder whether we are talking about conducting tests in a chemistry lab or about producing beautiful photographs. Here's a look at some of these terms. We have decoded them for you to better understand what they mean.

Colour Temperature

Colour temperature is one of the more confusing terms in the world of photography. After all, what does 'temperature' have to do with photographs, you ask. While the name doesn't give too much away, you may have heard people referring to 'cloudy white balance settings to correct 7000K colour temperature. If you are beginner, it's probably best to ignore this term and its meaning altogether. However, if you are already at a more advanced level, understanding this term and using it to your advantage could prove to be extremely useful.

Different light sources produce different colored lights. For instance, if you look at a candle burning, you can see it emit a reddish light. However, if you look at the midday sun's rays, you will notice a faint but noticeable blue tint. All of these colours can be expressed using numbers and the unit of measurement is Kelvin (K). This very number is what is known as colour temperature.

Why is Color Temperature Important?

The human eye is extremely adept at adjusting colour temperatures. What this means is that objects and their colours will look almost the same to the